

Structurally Distinct and Stage-Specific Adenylyl Cyclase Genes Play Different Roles in Dictyostelium Development

Geoffrey S. Pitt,* Nina Milona,* Jane Borleis,*
Kenneth C. Lin,* Randall R. Reed,†
and Peter N. Devreotes*

*Department of Biological Chemistry

†Howard Hughes Medical Institute

Johns Hopkins University School of Medicine
Baltimore, Maryland 21205

Summary

We have isolated two adenylyl cyclase genes, designated *ACA* and *ACG*, from *Dictyostelium*. The proposed structure for *ACA* resembles that proposed for mammalian adenylyl cyclases: two large hydrophilic domains and two sets of six transmembrane spans. *ACG* has a novel structure, reminiscent of the membrane-bound guanylyl cyclases. An *aca*[−] mutant, created by gene disruption, has little detectable adenylyl cyclase activity and fails to aggregate, demonstrating that cAMP is required for cell-cell communication. cAMP is not required for motility, chemotaxis, growth, and cell division, which are unaffected. Constitutive expression in *aca*[−] cells of either *ACA* or *ACG*, which is normally expressed only during germination, restores aggregation and the ability to complete the developmental program. *ACA* expression restores receptor and guanine nucleotide-regulated adenylyl cyclase activity, while activity in cells expressing *ACG* is insensitive to these regulators. Although they lack *ACA*, which has a transporter-like structure, the cells expressing *ACG* secrete cAMP constitutively.

Introduction

Cyclic AMP coordinates the early stages of the developmental program during which *Dictyostelium* aggregates into a multicellular organism. Triggered by nutrient depletion, this developmental program culminates in the formation of a fruiting body consisting of two distinct cell types that result from differentiation of pluripotent amoebae. Durable spores rest atop a stalk of nonviable, vacuolated cells. Extracellular cAMP, secreted by cells at maturing aggregation centers in an oscillatory fashion, initially serves to organize the amoebae during aggregation (Devreotes, 1982). Surrounding cells respond both by chemotaxis and by secreting more cAMP so that they relay the signal to cells further away. The cAMP oscillations are necessary for gene expression as well as aggregation; supplying constant levels of cAMP exogenously blocks the developmental program at its outset. Adenylyl cyclase activity and cAMP levels, low during growth, increase when aggregation begins (Klein, 1976). Within the resulting multicellular organism, cAMP continues to influence development. cAMP and its hydrolysis product adenosine act as morphogens and pattern organizers to

influence differentiation of individual cells into either stalk cells or spore cells (Devreotes, 1989; Schaap, 1986).

During aggregation, the extracellular cAMP functions analogously to hormones and other signals whose effects are mediated by G protein-linked signal transduction pathways (Gilman, 1987). Stimulation of cell surface cAMP receptors (*cAR1*) (Klein et al., 1988) activates a heterotrimeric G protein, whose α subunit has been designated *G_s2* (Kumagai et al., 1989; Pupillo et al., 1989), to elicit the chemotactic response and cAMP synthesis by a membrane-bound adenylyl cyclase activity. The gene products for both *cAR1* and *G_s2* share significant topological or sequence homology with their counterparts in mammalian G protein-linked pathways. Both *cAR1* and *G_s2* are necessary to elicit the chemotactic response and for early gene expression, as was demonstrated by targeted gene disruption of the *cAR1* and *G_s2* genes (Kumagai et al., 1991; Sun and Devreotes, 1991). These *cAR1*[−] and *G_s2*[−] cells fail to respond to cAMP stimuli, fail to aggregate, and are blocked in the developmental program.

Two lines of evidence suggest that *G_s2* does not activate adenylyl cyclase directly, however. Guanine nucleotides stimulate adenylyl cyclase in *G_s2*[−] lysates (Kesbeke et al., 1988), suggesting that, although *G_s2* is necessary for transducing the cAMP signal from *cAR1* to adenylyl cyclase, a different guanine nucleotide-binding protein directly couples to adenylyl cyclase. Recent observations suggest that mechanisms of indirect activation of adenylyl cyclase also occur in mammalian systems (Felder et al., 1989; Tang and Gilman, 1991).

Other lower eukaryotes also utilize cAMP, but activate adenylyl cyclase through a signal transduction pathway different from the G protein motifs found in mammals and in *Dictyostelium*. In *Saccharomyces cerevisiae*, for example, *RAS* gene products rather than a heterotrimeric G protein activate adenylyl cyclase (Kataoka et al., 1985). The ligand and receptor that activate *RAS* have not yet been identified. The disparities between the activation of adenylyl cyclase in the mammalian and yeast signal transduction pathways are reflected in differences within the structures of the adenylyl cyclases themselves.

cDNAs for several adenylyl cyclases from higher eukaryotes recently isolated predict integral membrane proteins of about 1100 aa that span the membrane 12 times and contain two homologous cytoplasmic domains; one, designated *C₁*, lies between the sixth and seventh transmembrane segments, and a second, *C₂*, is at the carboxyl terminus. Within each of these cytoplasmic domains is a region of homology (the *C_{1a}* and *C_{2a}* regions) that is also found in the catalytic domain of *S. cerevisiae* adenylyl cyclase (Krupinski et al., 1989). Outside of these domains, the yeast and the mammalian adenylyl cyclases share little homology; the yeast enzyme has a distinct repetitive sequence motif, no transmembrane spans, and only the one catalytic domain. Since adenylyl cyclase in aggregating *Dictyostelium* cells has been shown to be activated by a

G protein (Theibert and Devreotes, 1986) that does not appear to be a *ras* gene product (Reymond et al., 1986), we predicted that the aggregation adenylyl cyclase would more closely resemble mammalian adenylyl cyclase.

Results

Two Structurally Diverse Adenylyl Cyclases

We designed degenerate primers based on the C₂ domains (Gao and Gilman, 1991) of Type I and Type III adenylyl cyclases, and *rutabaga*, an adenylyl cyclase involved in learning and memory in *Drosophila* (Bakalyar and Reed, 1990; Krupinski et al., 1989; Levin et al., 1992), for use in polymerase chain reaction (PCR) to amplify part of a C₂ domain from a *Dictyostelium* adenylyl cyclase. The resulting product was used to screen genomic libraries from which we isolated the gene. We designated this gene ACG, since it is expressed during germination (see below).

Analysis of the nucleotide sequence from the ACG genomic fragments predicts an open reading frame of 2574 nt encoding an 858 aa protein, after the removal of two introns (Figure 1A). *Dictyostelium* introns are small, rare, and readily identifiable by sequence because of their almost exclusive AT composition, as well as by consensus splice sites (Kimmel and Firtel, 1982). Their size and location were confirmed by PCR analysis of mRNA (Perkin-Elmer Cetus, 1990). The 3' end of the coding region is unusually AT rich; in the last 375 nt, there are only 41 G or C residues. Sixty of the carboxy-terminal 125 codons are AAT, encoding asparagine, including one stretch of 14 contiguous asparagines. Asparagine-rich sequences appear in other *Dictyostelium* proteins, such as several members of the cAMP receptor family (R. Johnson, C. Saxe, A. Kimmel, and P. D., unpublished data), although the functions of these repeats are not yet known. Repetitive elements contained within open reading frames are found in other organisms, such as the *opa* repeat in *Drosophila* (Wharton et al., 1985), yet their function has also not been identified.

The absence of ACG mRNA in aggregating cells (see below) prompted us to renew our search for the adenylyl cyclase involved in cell-cell signaling. We used a fragment of ACG containing the portion that encodes its C₂-like domain to screen at low stringency a cDNA library made from aggregating cells. Five overlapping clones were initially isolated, all of which appeared to be derived from the same mRNA as judged from sequence and cross-hybridization analysis. Since none contained a full-length message, the largest was used to screen both the genomic and cDNA libraries to obtain overlapping fragments that constituted the entire gene. This gene was labeled ACA to denote that it is an adenylyl cyclase expressed during aggregation (see below).

The ACA nucleotide sequence predicts a 4221 nt open reading frame encoding a 1407 aa protein (Figure 1B). There are three introns, as demonstrated by comparing sequence from the cDNA and the genomic DNA isolates, each of which has consensus splice sites and the typical AT-rich base composition (Kimmel and Firtel, 1982). Analysis of the cDNA clones identifies three additional regions

A	
HKKTFVKILS KSYVEGYFVG FFIGLILAI FGSVCIFSF MHYSEENS	
IQMDLERSK QIHNQIMNA MYLLSIOITL KALYVNPFP DRNDFNVFLN	100
TTLKNSEFQY LFWIKKINNN DRNCFEEKFS KEIKDTFQIY SFDETNISIH	
VAKNKSSYFP ILHAFPOINK DIIGLDINST DYMNETIKKS IPNKKPTVHL	200
NKKVLLSKRN IDILIVSPII VTKLESTNE TMEDSHISS GLFLMEKNVQ	
ASRIEVENGN DFTIFLSTN GRIVYQENYL NFKTLVQVHE SGLFEDRLKY	300
ESSLKIADCV LKLWIFTTEE YENNSKTYLP LLVSIISAVI LVLLITYSDV	
QRKQSLIAK IMREKNLNIN KILPLEVSVK LENGEDVVAE RSNNAVFPFL	400
DIAGFTRFSS IHSPEQVIQV LIKIFNSMDL LCAKHGIEKI KTIGDAYMAT	
CGIFFKCODI RHNTYKMLGF AMDVLEPIPK EMSFHLGLQV RVGICGPGVI	500
SGVISGYAKP HFDVWGDTVN VASRMESTGI AQQIHVSQV YQLGKEDFNF	
SERCDIHVK GKGRMKTWYL MGKSSDFSL KKDPSRSRVQ PSFLNRKQSH	600
VHCYPEPPS GLQALNIENN LNNTDAGCEN CSKILKTYA YSPDHSTSNY	
YHGGDNDSP PPSSLNNDLI DGSEYHDDPF PSDSVGVYHD TSKDIKEDEN	700
EQNETLLFNQ EQLKKQIEN IQRDLSLNDI IEAKILNIN NNNNINDNWI	
NNTNLNNNN DININNSDNV NNYENNNSFS DKIEKNDGDN NNINDNNYKS	800
TNENNIKSKT LFKDSKSLIN DIKMAKENCN NNDNNNNNN NNNNNNNDE	
NVESKKNK	
B	
MASSSPMFND HAIARSKYAL NSVLQQTNEL HDGNGGGGYT PSSPHLGGVS	
LNKSQNPQYT QYNNGGGGG GGGGHINPMH LNLNITNNH NNNHNNHNT	100
LSTPHNNNNH NNNHSTSHP HSNVAVNGGH LSQSIQQRG GLADLANAVI	
NRKNRSDSVQ TKMKPTOSAS NIESWAKVEK FSSSIFDSEK SKKSNIQKY	200
TLRLKNSYEK GYLHQHNSQ INLLRITNLI GIVAVSYGFT KEAIFMLIAI	
RILCFNLFAF SIFLSFLNRN ELYKLFHPL FLFSFTTFFI TILLEYKTTT	300
TTLILFLYVV IFCCLYALGC LLFIWVMVCN LMAICFIIF IFLESTLDNR	
NLISFVIYIL TMPLVGASHL YVLEKFRKES FIAEKKLIKE SNILKNEKEK	400
SSKLLNNILP DFIIENIVYD FEKRDIVPE PEEYKSCSIL CFDIVQFTNM	
SAKLDSPSRL VDLITQVFRE FDTVVLNRCG QKIKTDGDAV ICACGLSKSK	500
KAKQMPNSK STPLQSTSS TSVNNIDLDK DNKDNNNNN NNNKSNNNFK	
NKNNIINNHN NSNSNNTTNN NSNNNNITTS QNDODDEIE DSELEHFEKL	600
IDVAIEIMNL DVLKETGTE GIQVQFRGI AAGSVYGVV GSQYQFDIW	
GDTIARSHIL EQLGQPGKVH VGETIMTHKN WLKKWQYNN IVSNSECKDQ	700
EHDYEFKKAH GECITSYFVD WKDDYREKKK KDLSCDFSIN KVLNAETIES	
KSNNNNNYNN NYNNNNYNN NYNNNNNNNS NNNNNEYGSS SSSSVLGEA	800
VTEQIDCNNT NPPLQHKKSQ SILTNNDI VSPSLTNSP ILDTTVNNHN	
NNNNNNNNK NQNNIYGNHN NNEEDFKKS KSNSSFEIEM SNIKKPKSRF	900
IDRVMGILHH VKISNDKICK EIIQIDEDFV KVTKLKXYF FFENLTTEKF	
FHKYVIINNV VETKFLVIG LILHLMFYLD DHINDSAPYF NSNVILVMG	1000
IAFLVYIGLS FTRIFRTPLV YQIAFFILLC AFGVCTVLEL IRFQNPLARS	
SLTRVCATLF YLNVPHSLNF LSVLFNLFI FSFFIICSL ISPTLNNHLY	1100
ETDYIGFVIV LLIQICSSYG KKLAMRKAWV VNCKINFNTI SVNKEKDFN	
FLKKSIFPQS ALTKLRDMID TPNIETKGI VYQPHQDVS I MFQIAGPQE	1200
YDEPKDLIKK LNDIFSFFDG LLNQKYGGTV EKIKTIGNY MAVSGLDGSP	
SFLEKMSDFA LDVKAYTNSV AISRVRIGI SHGLVAGCI GISRAKFDVV	1300
GDTANTASRM EQNAQDNEIM VTHSVYERLN KLFYFDDEKE ILVKGKGKQV	
THVLGKGDLD EQTNKWTTPK PEWVNVNATP AGIASPLSGT LLGEIGSFTT	1400
PRHLSS	

Figure 1. Deduced Amino Acid Sequences of ACG and ACA
(A) Deduced amino acid sequence of ACG. (B) Deduced amino acid sequence of ACA.

of AT-rich sequence within the coding region. These encode for asparagine-rich amino acid sequences similar to the one noted in ACG.

The deduced amino acid sequence of ACA contains two hydrophilic domains (Kyte and Doolittle, 1982) that exhibit homology with a single domain in ACG. The amino-terminal regions of these domains are also homologous

ACA-C _{1a}	...NEKEKS	SKLLNNILPD	PII	ENIVYDFEKR	DIVIVEPEEY
ACA-C _{2a}	..KEDKFN	..FLKSTIFF	QSAL.TKLRD	MIDTPNIETK	GIVVYQF..H
ACG-C	ITYSVQDQRKQ	KSLLAKIMRE	KNNLINKILP	LEVSVKLENG	EDVVAER..S
I-C _{1a}	LRLEDENEKQ	ERLLMSLLPR	NVAMEMKEDF	LKPPERIFHK	..IYIQR..H
I-C _{2a}	DDMEKVKLDN	KRILFNLLPA	HVAQ..HFL..	MSNPRNMD..	..LYYQS..Y
Consen.	K K	LL LP	A K	E	VY Q
ACA-C _{1a}	KSCSILCFDI	VQFTNMSAKL	D...SPS	RLVDLLTQVFREF	DTVVLRN...
ACA-C _{2a}	QDVSMFIQI	AGFQEY...	..DE.PK	DLIKKLNDFISFF	DGLLNQKYGG
ACG-C	NNACVFELDI	AGFTRF...	SIHSSPE	QVIQVLKIFNSM	DLCAKH...
I-C _{1a}	DNVSILFADI	VGFTGL...	AQCTSAQ	ELVKLLNELFGKF	DELATENHCR
I-C _{2a}	SQGVMFASI	PNFNDFYIEL	DNNMGV	ECLRLLENIADF	DELMDKDFYK
Consen.	VSI F DI	GFT	S	L LL IF	F D L
ACA-C _{1a}	GCQKIKTDGD	AYICACGLKS	KKKAKKQMPN	SKSTPLLQST	--poly N--
ACA-C _{2a}	TVEKIKTIGN	TYMAVSGLDG	SP.....		
ACG-C	GIEKIKTIGD	AYMAVCGIFP	KC.....		
I-C _{1a}	RIKILGD	CYCYSGLTQ	FK.....		
I-C _{2a}	DEKIKTIGS	TYMAVGLAP	TA.....		
Consen.	EKIKTIGD	YMA	GL		
ACA-C _{1a}	TSGNDODDER	IEDSELEHFE	KLIDVAIEIM	NLDVLKETGN	TEGQVQFRC
ACA-C _{2a}		SFLE	KMSDFALDV.	.KAYTNSVAI	SR...VVRI
ACG-C	DDI	RHNTY.....	KMLGFAMDV.	.LEFIPK.EM	SFHLGLQVRV
I-C _{1a}	TDH	AHCCV.....	..EMGLDM.	.IDTITSVAE	ATEVDLNMVRV
I-C _{2a}	GK	AKKISSHLS	TLADFAIEM.	.FDVLDEINY	QSYNDVFLRV
Consen.			K DFA D	D	RV
ACA-C _{1a}	GIAAGSVYGG	V.GSIQK	YQFDINGDTIARS	HTLEQLGQPG	KVHVGETINT
ACA-C _{2a}	GISHGPLVAG	C.GIISR	AKFDVWGDNTANTA	SRMQSNAQDN	EIMVTHSVY.
ACG-C	GIHCGPVISG	VSGYIAK	PHFDVWGDVNVVA	SRMESTGIAG	QIHVSDRVY.
I-C _{1a}	GLHTGRVLCG	V.GLLRK	WQYDVWSNDVTLA	NVMEAAGLPG	KVHITKTLL
I-C _{2a}	GINVGPVAVG	V.GAIRR	PQYDIWNGTNNVA	SRMDSTGVQG	RIQVTEEVH.
Consen.	GI	GPV G V G I K	QFDVWGDVNV A	SRMES G G	IHVT V
ACA-C _{1a}	HKNWLKQWQY	NYNIVSNSEC	KDQEHDEYEFH	KAHGECITSY	FVDWK.....
ACA-C _{2a}	..ERLNKLFY	.F.....	..DDEKEIL.V	KGKGKMTVTHV	LKG K.....
ACG-C	..Q.LGRDEF	NF.....	..SERCDIIHV	KGGRMKTWY	LMG K.....
I-C _{1a}	..ACLN.....		..GOYVE	EGCHGRNSF	LKTHNLETF
I-C _{2a}	..RLIRRGSY	RF.....	..VCRCKVS.V	KKGEMLTFF	LEG RTDGN.
Consen.	L K Y F		D V	KKG M T	L K

Figure 2. Homology Among the C Domains of ACA, ACG, and Type I Adenylyl Cyclase

Alignment of the C_{1a} and C_{2a} domains of ACA and Type I (bovine brain) adenylyl cyclase and the C domain of ACG. Positions where at least 3 of the 5 aa are identical are indicated by boldface in the consensus sequence. The poly asparagine-rich region in ACA-C_{1a} has been labeled poly N. The sequences aligned are aa 386–722 for ACA-C_{1a} (the poly N region is 532–609); 1144–1360 for ACA-C_{2a}; 345–573 for ACG; 238–487 for Type I-C_{1a}; and 806–1067 for ACA-C_{2a}. The C_{1a} and C_{2a} domains for Type I (Gao and Gilman, 1991) were extended slightly on either side to demonstrate additional homology.

with the domains C_{1a} and C_{2a} of mammalian adenylyl cyclases (Figure 2; mammalian adenylyl cyclase Type I is shown in the figure). The amino and carboxy hydrophilic domains in ACA have been labeled ACA-C₁ and ACA-C₂, respectively, to reflect the nomenclature for the mammalian adenylyl cyclase family (Gao and Gilman, 1991). The single domain in ACG has been labeled ACG-C. Relevant pairwise comparisons (% similarity) are 52% ACA-C_{1a} vs. I-C_{1a}; 51% ACA-C_{2a} vs. I-C_{2a}; 61% ACA-C_{1a} vs. ACG; 58% ACA-C_{2a} vs. ACG; 53% ACG vs. I-C_{1a}; 60% ACG vs. I-C_{2a}. One of the asparagine-rich sequences in ACA interrupts the C_{1a} domain in a region that is least conserved among the C domains of all adenylyl cyclases.

The topology of the two putative adenylyl cyclases differed. Hydropathy analysis reveals that ACA contains two hydrophobic regions, one amino terminal to ACA-C₁ and the other between ACA-C₁ and ACA-C₂. Each hydrophobic region contains candidates for six closely spaced transmembrane spans. The predicted topology of ACA in the membrane, therefore, resembles that predicted for the family of mammalian adenylyl cyclases (Figure 3). In contrast, ACG has only two candidates for transmembrane spans. A single putative transmembrane span (denoted as "II" in Figure 1A and Figure 3) is shown at the amino-

terminal side of the catalytic domain. A second segment near the amino terminus likely represents a signal sequence for insertion into the endoplasmic reticulum (Pugsley, 1989).

We propose that ACG's putative catalytic domain is in the cytoplasm, leaving a large extracellular domain connected by the transmembrane span to the catalytic domain. This model is reminiscent of the structure proposed for the family of membrane-bound guanylyl cyclases. Members of this family of transmembrane receptors, such as the egg peptide receptor on sea urchin sperm, the mammalian atrial natriuretic peptide receptor, and the heat-stable enterotoxin receptor (Chinkers et al., 1989; Schulz et al., 1990; Singh et al., 1988), have an intracellular domain that shares homology with the cytoplasmic domains in the adenylyl cyclase family (Krupinski et al., 1989). ACG is 34% identical to the atrial natriuretic peptide receptor in this domain.

ACG Is an Adenylyl and Not a Guanylyl Cyclase

To demonstrate that the ACG gene encodes an adenylyl cyclase, Dictyostelium cells were transformed with an expression vector in which ACG is under transcriptional control of the Dictyostelium actin 15 promoter (Cohen et al., 1986; Dynes and Firtel, 1989). This promoter directs ACG expression during the growth stage of the life cycle, when endogenous adenylyl cyclase activity is very low. Lysates of these cells (ACG cells) had a basal adenylyl cyclase activity of 31.2 pmol/min per mg, 53-fold greater than lysates of control cells transformed with the vector only (0.6 pmol/min per mg). Adenylyl cyclase activity in ACG cells increased in the presence of Mn²⁺ (Ross and Gilman, 1980) to 307 pmol/min per mg, 10-fold over the basal activity, while activity in control cell lysates remained the same (1.3 pmol/min per mg).

Because ACG has a similar structure to and shares significant homology with the membrane-bound family of guanylyl cyclases, we also examined whether ACG is a guanylyl cyclase. ACG cell lysates had similar guanylyl cyclase activity to wild-type control cells, 5.9 pmol/min per mg and 6.4 pmol/min per mg, respectively. Further, adenylyl cyclase activity was not inhibited by 1 mM GTP, which is more than 3-fold higher than ACG's K_m for ATP (data not shown), demonstrating that ACG does not encode a guanylyl cyclase.

Stage-Specific Expression of ACA and ACG

To determine whether ACA could encode the adenylyl cyclase that controls aggregation, we examined whether its expression correlated with the induction of adenylyl cyclase activity during aggregation. Northern blot analysis demonstrates a 5.8 kb mRNA that first appears at three hours of development and peaks at 6 hr after starvation (Figure 4A). This time course parallels adenylyl cyclase activity during aggregation (Klein, 1976). ACA mRNA decreases after aggregation, and is induced again in the later stages of development. This pattern was observed in several independent experiments. ACA may therefore also synthesize the cAMP that influences differentiation

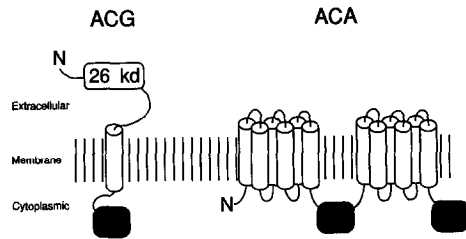


Figure 3. Models of ACA and ACG

The vertical bars represent the plasma membrane; "N" represents the respective amino termini; the boxed and shaded C_1 , C_2 , and C represent the respective C_1 and C_2 regions in ACA and the C region in ACG.

and morphogenesis of cells within the resulting multicellular structure (Schaap, 1986).

In striking contrast, ACG mRNA is expressed as a 3.5 kb transcript only at the culmination of the developmental program—after fruiting bodies have formed—and during germination (Figure 4B). Growing amoebae and cells in the starvation-induced developmental stage of the life cycle do not express ACG. Fruiting bodies contain about 10^5 dormant spores that germinate when nutrients again become available to release a single amoeba from each spore to begin the life cycle anew. During germination, the level of ACG mRNA increases. It peaks during the first 1.5 hr of germination and then decays, so that by 3 hr, when germination is complete, mRNA is no longer present (data not shown). Because ACG mRNA is absent in the amoebae that emerge from the spores at germination, any protein in these amoebae, which grow and divide indefinitely while nutrients are plentiful, would be soon diluted to less than one copy per cell. This implies that ACG functions specifically during germination.

ACA Is the Adenylyl Cyclase That Controls Aggregation

We examined whether ACA is the adenylyl cyclase that coordinates aggregation by creating an *aca*⁻ mutant by gene targeting (Figure 5A). The result was unambiguous. The *aca*⁻ cells failed to aggregate and remained as a homogeneous monolayer indefinitely (>100 hr), while the wild-type strain began to aggregate within 3 hr of starvation and formed fruiting bodies by 30 hr (Figures 5B and 5C). Nine independent uracil protrophic clones were examined by Southern blot analysis and phenotype. Eight of these were disrupted at the ACA locus and revealed a pattern identical to that shown for the mutant in Figure 5A. All of these eight failed to aggregate when starved on agar plates. Southern blot analysis of the ninth clone demonstrated that the ACA locus remained intact. This clone aggregated and completed the developmental program, identical to wild-type. To further confirm these results, an independent *aca*⁻ cell line was created in a thymidine auxotroph (Podgorski and Deering, 1984) by disrupting the ACA locus with the *Thy1* gene as a selectable marker (Dynes and Firtel, 1989). These cells also failed to aggregate when deprived of nutrients (data not shown). The disruption of the ACA locus thus correlates with the inability to aggregate, suggesting that ACA is the adenylyl cyclase gene that controls aggregation.

Moreover, ACA accounts for all measurable adenylyl cyclase activity. We assayed the *aca*⁻ and parental cells under a variety of conditions. After 5 hr of starvation, when adenylyl cyclase activity in wild-type cells is near its peak, lysates of *aca*⁻ cells have little detectable adenylyl cyclase activity even with the addition of Mn^{2+} or guanine nucleotides (Table 1). Lysates of the parental cells, in contrast, have adenylyl cyclase activity that is stimulated by both Mn^{2+} and guanine nucleotides.

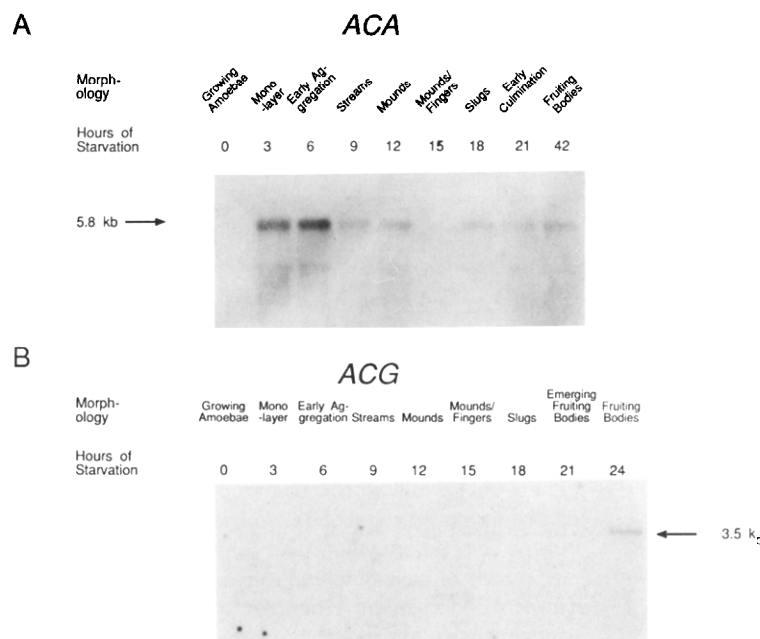


Figure 4. The Developmentally Regulated Expression of ACA and ACG

RNA was prepared from either growing cells or cells that had been starved on agar plates for the times indicated.

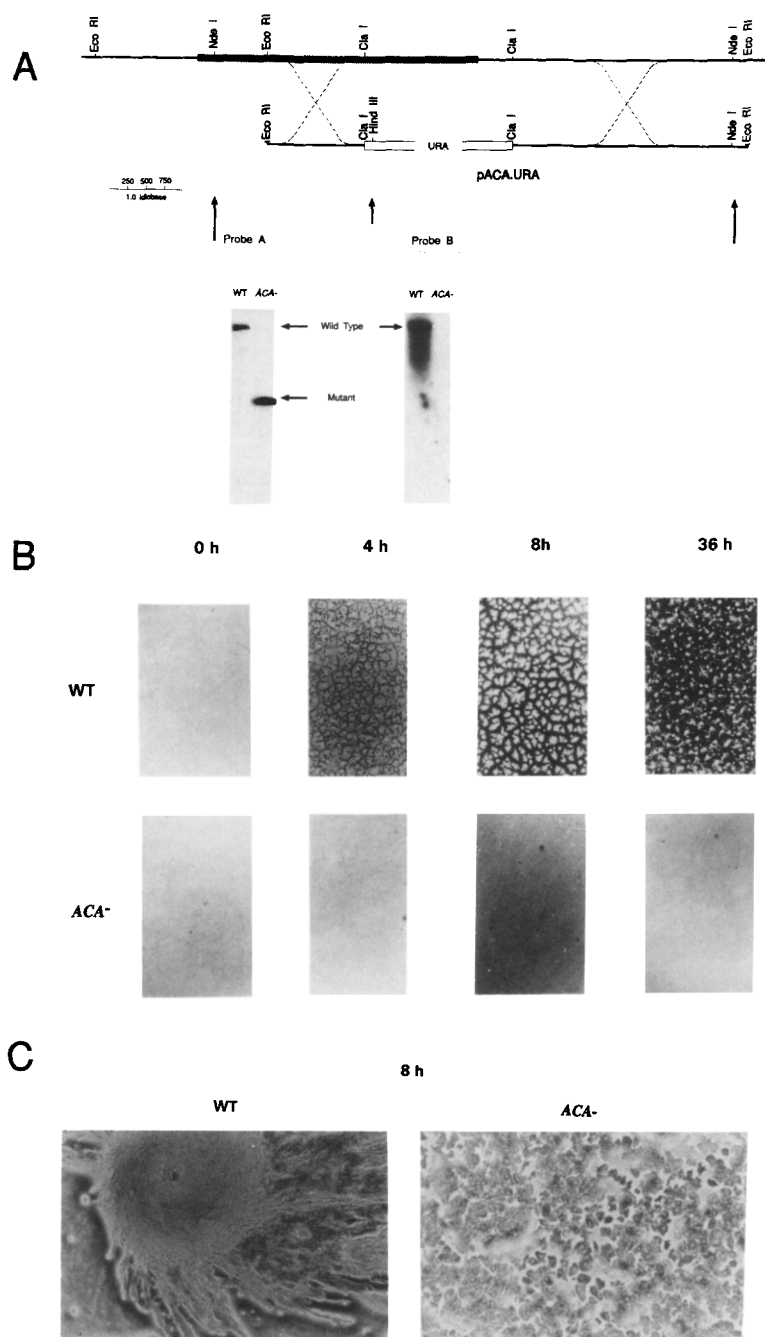


Figure 5. Disruption of the *ACA* Locus by Gene Targeting Results in the Loss of the Capability to Aggregate

(A) Southern blot analysis of genomic DNA from wild type and cells that had been transformed with a genomic fragment of *ACA* in which an internal *Cla*I fragment had been replaced with the Dictyostelium UMP Synthase gene (*pACA::URA*). The stippled box represents the *ACA* coding region. DNA was digested with *Nde*I and *Hind*III. In the parental cell line (WT), Probe A detects a ~6 kb *Nde*I fragment. Gene targeting introduces a *Hind*III site (within the UMP Synthase gene) into the *aca*⁻ mutants so that Probe A detects a 1.3 kb fragment. The filter was stripped and then probed with Probe B to confirm that the predicted double crossover event had occurred in the *aca*⁻ cells. Probe B detects the same ~6 kb *Nde*I fragment in the parental cell line, but does not hybridize to DNA from the *aca*⁻ cell line, confirming that the *Cla*I fragment had been lost from the genome.

(B) Developmental phenotype of *aca*⁻ cells. Wild-type and *aca*⁻ cells were placed on starvation plates and photographs were taken at the time indicated. Each photograph shows the middle one-third of a 100 cm² plate.

(C) Higher magnification showing aggregate or individual cells at the 8 hr stage.

The defect in the *aca*⁻ cells appeared to be very specific. The growth of the *aca*⁻ cells in shaking culture, when nutrients are plentiful, was indistinguishable from the parental cells. Time-lapse video analysis revealed that motility was qualitatively unaffected. Further, in tests of chemotaxis in gradients of extracellular cAMP, the *aca*⁻ cells performed as did wild type (data not shown).

ACA and ACG Rescue the *aca*⁻ Phenotype

Expression of *ACA* in *aca*⁻ cells restored the ability to aggregate, further demonstrating that the mutation was specific. Similar results were obtained whether we used an

ACA genomic fragment in an extrachromosomal vector (*aca*⁻/*ACA* cells) or the *ACA* genomic fragment cloned into an expression vector downstream from the actin 15 promoter, which directs high levels of expression during growth and development (*aca*⁻/*ACA*_{act-15} cells) (Cohen et al., 1986). Both of these cell lines regained the ability to aggregate when placed on nutrient-poor agar. Within 8 hr, cells had aggregated into mounds, and by 30 hr, fruiting bodies were evident.

As shown in Table 1, at the 5 hr stage of development, *aca*⁻/*ACA* cell lysates had similar levels of basal and unregulated (Mn^{2+} -dependent) adenylyl cyclase activity com-

Table 1. Cells Overexpressing ACA Have Adenylyl Cyclase Activity

Cell Line	Adenylyl Cyclase Activity (pmol·min ⁻¹ ·mg ⁻¹)		
	Mg ²⁺	Mn ²⁺	GTPγS
WT	3.2	8.4	70
5 hr starvation			
<i>aca</i> ⁻	0.1	0.7	0.2
5 hr starvation			
<i>aca</i> ⁻ / <i>ACA</i>	3.9	7.6	54
5 hr starvation			
<i>aca</i> ⁻ / <i>ACA</i> _{act-15}	26	96	63
growing cells			
<i>aca</i> ⁻ / <i>ACA</i> _{act-15}	80	190	290
5 hr starvation			

Adenylyl cyclase assays were performed as described (Theibert and Devreotes, 1986) in the presence or absence of 5 mM MnSO₄. GTPγS stimulation was determined in the presence of 40 μM GTPγS and 1 μM cAMP in the lysate.

pared with wild-type cells. While growing wild-type cells have almost undetectable adenylyl cyclase activity, the growing *aca*⁻/*ACA*_{act-15} cells had high levels of basal and Mn²⁺-dependent adenylyl cyclase activity (8-fold and 12-fold higher, respectively, than aggregation-competent wild-type cells), reflecting the high expression from the actin 15 promoter. When these cells were starved for 5 hr, basal and unregulated adenylyl cyclase activity increased slightly. The GTPγS-stimulated activity increased almost 5-fold, however, suggesting that the G protein that activates ACA is developmentally regulated.

The capacity of the *aca*⁻ cells to aggregate could be partially restored by constitutive expression of ACG. The *aca*⁻/*ACG*_{act-15} cells aggregated into small mounds (compared with wild type) within 6 hr after they were placed on a nonnutritive agar surface. Development continued within some of the mounds, which gave rise to small fruiting bodies. The spores in these fruiting bodies successfully germinated in rich media (data not shown). The appearance of mounds suggests that the cells were capable of chemotaxis and likely responded to cAMP through cAR1. It did not appear that the cells produced pulsatile waves of cAMP emanating from aggregation centers, however, since the territories were less than 3 mm.

To investigate whether ACA and ACG were coupled to cAR1, lysates of *aca*⁻/*ACA*_{act-15} and *aca*⁻/*ACG*_{act-15} cells were assayed for adenylyl cyclase activity after a 1 mM cAMP stimulus in vivo (Roos and Gerisch, 1976), as shown in Figure 6. Lysates of *aca*⁻/*ACA*_{act-15} cells made at 30 s, 1 min, 2 min, and 5 min after the cAMP stimulus had higher levels of adenylyl cyclase activity than untreated cells. Adenylyl cyclase activity peaked near 2 min after cAMP stimulation, about 5-fold higher than in untreated cells, before beginning to decay. In wild-type cells subjected to the same stimulus, adenylyl cyclase activity increased about 16-fold in response to a cAMP stimulus, and the peak was closer to 1 min. In contrast, adenylyl cyclase activity in *aca*⁻/*ACG*_{act-15} cells was insensitive to cAMP stimulation.

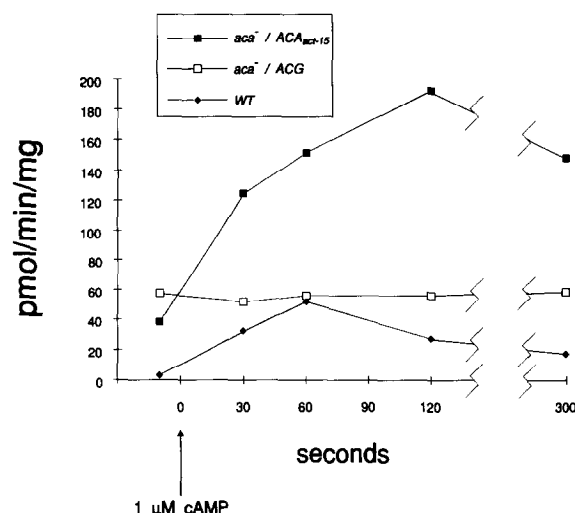


Figure 6. ACA but Not ACG Couples to cAR1

Adenylyl cyclase assays were performed on 5 hr starved Ax-3, *aca*⁻/*ACG*, and *aca*⁻/*ACA* cells stimulated with cAMP. Cells were removed at the times indicated, lysed, and assayed for one minute for adenylyl cyclase activity. The first point of every curve represents a sample that was assayed before the cAMP stimulus was applied.

Because ACG was not regulated by cAR1, we examined whether ACG was sensitive to guanine nucleotide regulation. The high adenylyl cyclase activity in ACG cell lysates (56.7 pmol/min per mg) was not altered by GTPγS addition (53.2 pmol/min per mg). Since GTPγS regulation may be due to a factor that is present in aggregation-competent cells, but not in growing cells, we examined adenylyl cyclase activity in lysates of *aca*⁻/*ACG*_{act-15} cells starved for 4 hr, the time when GTPγS stimulates ACA maximally (Theibert and Devreotes, 1986) and the time when multiple G proteins are expressed (Wu and Devreotes, 1991). Again, ACG was insensitive to the addition of GTPγS (15.0 pmol/min per mg basal activity; 12.6 pmol/min per mg with GTPγS addition). This suggests that this novel form of adenylyl cyclase may not be subject to regulation by a G protein.

ACA Is Not Necessary for cAMP Transport

Aggregation of the *aca*⁻/*ACG*_{act-15} cells, presumably in response to extracellular cAMP, suggested that *aca*⁻ cells were able to secrete cAMP. We exploited the constitutive adenylyl cyclase activity of ACG to measure cAMP secretion in *aca*⁻/*ACG*_{act-15} cells. Cells were pre-equilibrated with ³H-adenosine, and extracellular cAMP was measured after blocking extracellular phosphodiesterase activity with dithiothreitol (DTT) (Kessin et al., 1979). As shown in Figure 7, extracellular cAMP accumulated linearly with time, while adenylyl cyclase activity was unchanged. Similar results were obtained when the extracellular phosphodiesterase activity was blocked with 100 μM cAMP (data not shown). ACG, which has only a single transmembrane span, is topologically distinct from ACA and the mammalian adenylyl cyclases. Thus, although it is possible that ACA may be involved in cAMP secretion in wild-type cells,

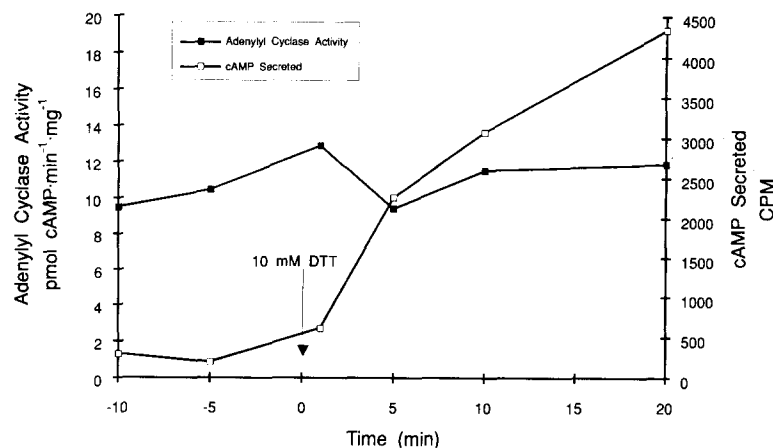


Figure 7. *aca*⁻ Cells Can Secrete cAMP

aca⁻/*ACG_{act-15}* cells were pre-equilibrated with ³H-adenosine. The supernatant of samples taken at the times indicated, either before or after the addition of 10 mM DTT to inhibit extracellular phosphodiesterase, was assayed for ³H-cAMP.

it is not required. The rapid secretion of cAMP from *aca*⁻/*ACG_{act-15}* cells demonstrates the existence of an independent pathway for cAMP secretion.

Discussion

Stimulation or inhibition of adenylyl cyclase in response to extracellular signals is part of the repertoire of cellular regulation in diverse organisms. Activation of adenylyl cyclase and the consequent synthesis of cAMP as an intracellular second messenger results, for example, from stimulation of β -adrenergic receptors by β -agonists in mammalian heart cells, while inhibition of adenylyl cyclase is mediated by α -agonists acting through α -adrenergic receptors (Dowd et al., 1989).

Dictyostelium contains two topologically distinct adenylyl cyclases: a twelve transmembrane-span form (ACA), topologically equivalent to the adenylyl cyclases identified in higher metazoans; and a novel single transmembrane-span form (ACG). The two genes are expressed at specific developmental stages and subject to different modes of regulation. ACA is expressed during aggregation and is the adenylyl cyclase activated in response to stimulation of cAR1, a G protein-linked receptor. ACG is expressed only during germination, and it is insensitive to guanine nucleotides.

Among adenylyl cyclases studied in eukaryotic protozoa, ACA is unique in its membrane topology and its regulation by guanine nucleotides. Neither the *S. cerevisiae* nor *Schizosaccharomyces pombe* adenylyl cyclases (Kataoka et al., 1985; Young et al., 1989), for example, share ACA's topology. While *S. cerevisiae* adenylyl cyclase activity is regulated by a *ras* gene product, and *S. pombe* adenylyl cyclase is insensitive to guanine nucleotide regulation, ACA is regulated by a surface receptor through a guanine nucleotide binding protein which does not appear to be the *ras* gene product. The appearance of a form of enzyme that is similar to that in mammals in one of the earliest multicellular organisms may signify an evolutionary branch point in the function of adenylyl cyclases and cAMP. The accessible genetics and biochemistry of Dictyostelium may make it a convenient vehicle for the study of mammalian adenylyl cyclases.

Our identification and studies of ACG demonstrate a novel form of eukaryotic adenylyl cyclase. In our model of ACG, a single transmembrane span connects a large extracellular domain, which may serve to bind ligands, to the internal catalytic domain. ACG's extracellular domain may be involved in recognition of an extracellular signal present during germination, when ACG is expressed, which leads to activation or inhibition of cAMP synthesis by the cytoplasmic domain. This suggests that ACG has the receptor component, signal transduction apparatus, and catalytic component within the same molecule. This model is analogous to the atrial natriuretic peptide receptor in mammals and to the chemotactic egg peptide receptor in sea urchin sperm, which are guanylyl cyclases whose activities are regulated by binding of their respective ligands to extracellular domain (Chinkers et al., 1989; Schulz et al., 1990; Singh et al., 1988). It should be noted that while there may be an evolutionary relationship, ACG is clearly an adenylyl cyclase and not a guanylyl cyclase. We are currently searching for a signal that activates or inhibits ACG activity and are investigating the function of ACG during germination in an *acg*⁻ cell line created by gene targeting. A search of the NBRF Protein Bank fails to identify any proteins with homology to ACG's putative extracellular domain.

ACA and the other examples of the twelve transmembrane-span form of adenylyl cyclase represent only one part of a multicomponent signal transduction pathway. As part of a G protein-linked signal transduction pathway, these adenylyl cyclases are indirectly coupled to a transmembrane domain receptor and may be just one of several intracellular effectors activated by the receptor. A single receptor has been shown to interact with several G proteins, and individual G proteins may activate several effectors (Freissmuth et al., 1989). Indeed, activation of ACA is only one of many cAMP-stimulated responses during aggregation in Dictyostelium.

Where the entire signal transduction apparatus (receptor, transducer, and effector) is combined in one molecule, such as in the family of membrane-bound guanylyl cyclases and possibly ACG, the extracellular signals are more specific in their intracellular effects, regulating the alteration in the concentration of only one second messenger.

ger molecule. It is conceivable that there may be tissue-specific or developmental stage-specific requirements for the regulation of cAMP as the sole intracellular second messenger in response to a particular stimulus in higher eukaryotes. The presence of both forms of adenylyl cyclase in *Dictyostelium* suggests that metazoa may express both this novel form as well as the twelve transmembrane form.

A family of genes from the *Trypanosoma equiperdum* and *brucei* species, homologous to ACG in sequence and structure, has recently been identified (Alexandre et al., 1990; Ross et al., 1991). Like ACG, the members of this family appear to have a single transmembrane span separating an extracellular domain from a cytoplasmic domain that shares homology with the catalytic domains of the adenylyl and guanylyl cyclase families. While expression of a partial open reading frame from a *T. equiperdum* gene in *S. cerevisiae* results in an increase in adenylyl cyclase activity, it has not yet been demonstrated whether the *T. brucei* genes encode adenylyl or guanylyl cyclases. The functions of these enzymes in the *Trypanosome* life cycle have not yet been identified. All of the mammalian adenylyl cyclases for which the genes have been cloned have the twelve transmembrane domain structure and are regulated by G proteins, but an adenylyl cyclase activity insensitive to guanine nucleotide regulation has been identified in mammalian sperm (Garbers and Kopf, 1980). This enzyme may be structurally homologous to ACG.

Constitutive expression of ACA allowed us to investigate the development of its sensitivity to guanine nucleotides. The time course of the appearance of the factor responsible for this regulation is similar to that of ACA gene expression. Since ACA is not regulated by a *ras* gene product (Reymond et al., 1986), we predict that a heterotrimeric G protein confers the guanine nucleotide sensitivity. A recently isolated α subunit gene whose pattern of developmental expression mirrors ACA expression may be this G protein (Wu and Devreotes, 1991).

It appears that two G proteins are involved in receptor-mediated activation of ACA in vivo. In cell lysates, cAR1 remains coupled to $G_{\alpha 2}$, but the cAR1/ $G_{\alpha 2}$ complex is uncoupled from ACA (Theibert and Devreotes, 1986; Van Haastert, 1984). Further, while there is no cAR1-mediated ACA activation in intact $g_{\alpha 2}^-$ cells, ACA activity remains fully sensitive to guanine nucleotide regulation in $g_{\alpha 2}^-$ cell lysates.

G proteins that are not directly coupled to the activating receptor also appear to be involved in the activation of adenylyl cyclases in other systems. In human neutrophil membranes, for example, activation of adenylyl cyclase by guanine nucleotides appears to be dependent on a different G protein than that coupled to the fMet-Leu-Phe receptor (Verghese et al., 1985). Similarly, in A9 L cells transfected with the m1 muscarinic receptor, carbachol activates synthesis of cAMP in intact cells but not in cell membranes (Felder et al., 1989). Further, in cells expressing recombinant Type II adenylyl cyclase, cAMP synthesis can be triggered via receptors coupled to G_q , but activated $G_{\alpha q}$ alone does not stimulate the enzyme.

Recent in vitro studies of several subtypes of mamma-

lian adenylyl cyclases have demonstrated alternative mechanisms of G protein regulation that may explain these observations. While the Type I enzyme can be stimulated by activated $G_{\alpha s}$, maximal stimulation of Type II requires $G_{\alpha s}$ and $G\beta\gamma$ (Tang and Gilman, 1991). Thus, in the examples cited, receptor stimulation may result in release of a G protein $\beta\gamma$ complex that interacts with $G_{\alpha s}$ to activate adenylyl cyclase. Likewise, the requirement for two G proteins in the activation of ACA could be explained if stimulation of the cAR1 results in the release of the $\beta\gamma$ complex from $G_{\alpha 2}$, which then interacts with the as yet unidentified $G_{\alpha s}$. It is important to note, however, that ACA is no more homologous to Type II than to Type I.

We have demonstrated that adenylyl cyclase and cAMP are essential for *Dictyostelium* aggregation. We have also shown, by disrupting the ACA locus, that ACA is not necessary for cell motility, chemotaxis, cell division, or viability. Preliminary evidence suggests that the mutation in *synag 49*, a cell deficient in aggregation and without detectable adenylyl cyclase activity (Pupillo et al., 1988), is at a locus different from ACA; we have been able to complement the aggregation-deficient phenotype in *aca^-/synag 49* diploid cells (Coukell et al., unpublished data). Since the *aca^-* cells lack detectable adenylyl cyclase activity, they must be devoid of cAMP. Given the universal presence of adenylyl cyclase in eukaryotic cells, it is intriguing that *aca^-* cells are unaffected in these cellular processes.

The proposed structure for ACA and the mammalian adenylyl cyclases, two sets of six transmembrane spans and two homologous cytoplasmic domains, is topologically similar to a superfamily of proteins that are involved in the transport of small molecules across the plasma membrane. While there is little homology among the amino acid sequences, the family of facilitative glucose transporters (Gould and Bell, 1990) and the MDR (multiple drug resistance) gene products, which excrete cytotoxic drugs (Juranka et al., 1989), are two examples in which the topological similarities are particularly striking. Cyclic AMP secretion is displayed by many cell types, and it has been speculated that adenylyl cyclases may facilitate its transport (Krupinski et al., 1989). Since the *aca^-/ACG_{act-15}* cells constitutively synthesize and secrete cAMP, however, there must be cAMP transporters that are unrelated to the twelve transmembrane form of adenylyl cyclases. It is possible that ACA and the mammalian adenylyl cyclase might be involved in transport of a different molecule.

As shown in Figure 6, ACA activity is sensitive to external cAMP stimuli. Adenylyl cyclase activity in wild-type and *aca^-/ACA_{act-15}* cell lysates increases within the first 2 min after a cAMP stimulus and decreases to its pre-stimulus level within 10 min. Thus, ACA is both positively and negatively regulated by extracellular cAMP. This regulation is part of the mechanism that establishes the oscillatory cAMP waves during aggregation.

As shown in Figure 6, adenylyl cyclase activity in *aca^-/ACG_{act-15}* is insensitive to external cAMP stimuli, yet expression of ACG in the *aca^-* cells is able to rescue the phenotype partially. This suggests that supplying an endogenous source of cAMP is sufficient to restore aggregation and development in *aca^-* cells. Rescue of the *aca^-* cells can there-

fore be used to establish activity of an expressed adenylyl cyclase. Dictyostelium signal transduction utilizes components (seven transmembrane-spanning receptors, G proteins, and effectors) that are homologous to their mammalian counterparts. Since mammalian proteins have been successfully expressed in Dictyostelium (Devreotes, 1989), the *aca*⁻ cells might provide a valuable tool for the study of mammalian signal transduction.

Experimental Procedures

Cloning of ACG and ACA

Protocols were performed as described, unless otherwise noted (Sambrook et al., 1989). PCR (Saiki et al., 1988) was performed on 100 ng of genomic DNA using primers RR168 5'-CCNGTNTNGCNGGNGT-3' and RR170 5'-GCNACA/GTTNACNGTT/GT-3', where N is A, C, G, or T. Fifty cycles of PCR were performed with a cycle profile of 94°C for 45 s, 37°C for 1 min, and 55°C for 3 min. A 74 bp product, which was similar in size to a predicted 71 bp product, was excised from the gel, eluted, and subjected to an additional round of PCR. This newly amplified product was subcloned and sequenced. This product corresponds to the codons for aa 498–521 in the ACG sequence. A 43-mer oligonucleotide, RR180, 5'-GTCACCCCAACATCGAAATGTGGCTT-GCATAACCTGAAATG-3', corresponding to sequence between the PCR primers, was then used to screen EcoRI-digested Dictyostelium genomic DNA cloned into λ ZAP (Stratagene), which yielded a 1.7 kb EcoRI fragment, p λ 22. This fragment was used to screen a Sau3AI partially digested genomic DNA library cloned into pAT153 Δ (gift of R. A. Firtel, University of California, San Diego), from which a 4.3 kb overlapping genomic fragment, pG1D, was isolated. These two genomic fragments overlap by about 400 nt.

A PCR product corresponding to part of the catalytic domain from ACG was used as a probe to screen at low stringency ~50,000 clones of a λ gt11 cDNA library made from aggregation competent Dictyostelium (Klein et al., 1988). This PCR product was generated with primers GP2 (5'-GGACTAGTTGAATGATCGGGTGAGTAAGTCATAAGT-3') and GP4 (5'-CCTACTTACCACTTCTGTATCAATAATAT-3'). Hybridization conditions were: 50°C in 5 $\times$ SSC, 5 $\times$ Denhardt's solution, 0.1% SDS, 0.1 mg/ml sonicated salmon sperm DNA. The filters were washed at 55°C in 2 $\times$ SSC and 0.1% SDS. Five cross-hybridizing inserts were isolated. One of these, p λ 5, was used to screen the library of EcoRI-digested genomic DNA cloned into λ ZAP at high stringency (filters were washed at 65°C in 2 $\times$ SSC, 1% SDS). This yielded a 6 kb fragment labeled pGSP2. Since pGSP2 did not contain the entire ACA coding region, the 5' ClaI–EcoRI fragment of pGSP2 was randomly primed and used to screen the library from aggregation-competent cells. Out of 50,000 phage screened, 41 positives were isolated. To determine which of these included additional 5' sequence, they were screened by PCR using primer ACA1 (5'-GTAAGCATCACCAT-CAGT-3') and either λ_{1100} or λ_{1100} (primers designed to flank the EcoRI cloning site in λ gt11). One isolate, labeled λ_{1100} -ACA1, gave an additional 0.5 kb of 5' sequence. This fragment was then used to screen the library of EcoRI-digested genomic DNA, from which pGSP8 was isolated. This fragment contained 2 kb of additional 5' sequence.

Sequence from both ACG and ACA was determined on both strands using Sequenase (US Biochemical Corp.). For one small stretch of ACA, around aa 850, sequence was determined with Taq polymerase on an ABI sequencer. The two introns in ACG and the three in ACA were confirmed either by sequencing RNA-PCR products generated with appropriate primers or by sequencing cDNA isolates. The presence of the AT-rich sequence in the ACA and ACG coding regions was confirmed by sequencing multiple RNA-PCR products and by sequencing cDNAs. A cDNA library made from RNA isolated from germinating cells, from which we isolated a partial cDNA for ACG, in order to confirm its AT-rich sequence and 3' end, was a gift of H. Ennis (Roche).

Construction of Cell Lines

ACG Cells

A full-length construct of ACG was created by inserting a fragment

from p λ 22 into pG1D at the common XbaI site to create pGACG. The large (about 2 kb) untranslated region at the 5' end was deleted by cutting a BglII–HindIII fragment from pGACG and inserting this into a plasmid containing a 5' cDNA, created by RNA-PCR at the BglII site. This leaves less than 100 nt of sequence 5' to the initiating ATG. This construct was then cloned into the Dictyostelium expression vector pJK1 (J.-Y. Kim, M. Caterina, and P. D., unpublished data), which is a derivative of the Dictyostelium extrachromosomal vector pATANB43 (Dynes and Firtel, 1989) into which the actin 15 promoter and the 2H3 terminator have been inserted. This construct was labeled pGSP1. The pJK1 plasmid bears the neomycin resistance gene that allows the selection of stable transformants. The plasmid pGSP1 or the pJK1 vector alone was electroporated (Howard et al., 1988) into wild-type strain, Ax-3, stable transformants selected, and one, ACG cells or vector control cells, was chosen for further study.

aca Cells

The ACA gene was disrupted by gene targeting. A uracil auxotroph RF1 (gift of R. A. Firtel) was transformed (Howard et al., 1988) with a genomic fragment of ACA, pGSP2, in which a 2.0 ClaI fragment was replaced by the UMP-synthase gene (pACA.URA) (Kalpaxis et al., 1991). Uracil prototrophs were selected, and their genomic DNA was isolated (Nellen et al., 1987) to ascertain whether the ACA gene had been disrupted. The DNA was digested with NdeI and HindIII, and Southern blot analysis was performed using randomly primed probes.

aca/ACA Cells

A full-length genomic construct of ACA (pGSP9) was created by ligating the pGSP8 insert into pGSP7, a derivative of pGSP2 in which 2.5 kb of 3' untranslated sequence was removed. pGSP9 contains about 1 kb of sequence 5' to the ACA initiating methionine codon. The ACA fragment from pGSP9 was then inserted into the Dictyostelium extrachromosomal expression vector pATANB43 (Dynes and Firtel, 1989), and the resulting fragment was labeled pGSP10. The *aca*⁻ cells were transformed with pGSP10, and transformants were selected in HL-5 plus 20 μ g/ml G418.

aca/ACA_{act-15} Cells

The ACA fragment from pGSP9 was inserted into the Dictyostelium expression vector pB18 (Johnson et al., 1991) in the sense orientation. The resulting plasmid was labeled pKL2. The *aca*⁻ cells were transformed with pKL2, and transformants were selected in HL-5 plus 20 μ g/ml G418.

aca/ACG_{act-15} Cells

aca⁻/ACG_{act-15} cells were prepared by transformation of *aca*⁻ cells with pGSP1. The resulting cells were grown in HL-5 supplemented with 20 mg/ml G418.

Adenylyl Cyclase Assays

Adenylyl cyclase assays were performed as described (Theibert and Devreotes, 1986) in the absence or presence of 5 mM MnSO₄ on growing or 5 hr starved cells as indicated (Devreotes et al., 1987). GTP γ S stimulation was determined in the presence of 40 μ M GTP γ S and 1 μ M cAMP in the lysate. Each assay was determined in triplicate. Experiments were repeated at least three times with similar results, and typical assays are shown.

To examine the effects of cAMP stimulation in vivo, adenylyl cyclase assays were performed on growing or 5 hr starved cells stimulated with cAMP as described (Roos and Gerisch, 1976). In brief, cells shaken on ice were stimulated with 1 μ M cAMP and 10 mM DTT. Cells were removed at the times indicated, lysed, and assayed for adenylyl cyclase activity. The first point of every curve in Figure 6 represents a sample that was assayed before the cAMP stimulus was applied. Experiments were repeated at least twice for all three cell lines, and similar results were obtained.

Guanylyl Cyclase Assay

Guanylyl cyclase activity was measured in Dictyostelium whole cell lysates of 1.6×10^5 cells and in homogenized rat brain as described (Schultz and Bohme, 1984), except the Dictyostelium reactions were performed at 22°C (as were the Dictyostelium adenylyl cyclase assays). To serve as a positive control, a 45,000 $\times$ g supernatant from whole rat brain homogenized in 50 mM Tris (pH 7.5) was used. Each point was assayed in triplicate. This assay was repeated twice with similar results.

Northern Blot Analysis

RNA was prepared as described (Klein et al., 1988) from either growing cells or cells that had been starved on agar plates for the times indicated. Five micrograms of total RNA for each time point was size fractionated on a 1.2% agarose gel and then transferred to a nitrocellulose filter. A partial cDNA isolate (pl4) was randomly primed and used as a probe for ACA. A randomly primed 1.2 kb EcoRI fragment that encompasses the 5' half of the coding region was used to analyze the expression of ACG. A randomly primed probe for the G_β subunit (P. Lilly and P. D., unpublished data), which is constitutively expressed during all stages of the life cycle, was used to determine that an equivalent amount of RNA was loaded in each lane.

Secretion of cAMP by *aca*/*ACG*_{act-15} Cells

Cells were labeled with (2,8-³H)-adenine as described (Roos et al., 1975), except cells were labeled at 1 mCi/ml with cells shaking at 1 × 10⁸ cells per ml in phosphate buffer for 1 hr. Cells were washed extensively (at least 6 times) and resuspended at 8 × 10⁷ cells per ml. Extracellular phosphodiesterase activity was inhibited with 10 mM DTT, and samples were taken at the times indicated. The sample was spun for 15 s at full speed in a microfuge and the supernatant was added to a solution containing cAMP and SDS. ³H-cAMP was quantitated as described (Salomon, 1979). The identity of the ³H-material as cAMP was confirmed by its comigration with standard when chromatographed in 95% ethanol, 1 M ammonium acetate (70:30). This experiment was repeated three times, and three additional times using 100 μM cAMP instead of 10 mM DTT to inhibit extracellular phosphodiesterase, and similar results were obtained.

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GenBank Accession Numbers

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